
NEWS

Menlo Park Joins Growing List of Bay Area Cities Reining in Flock Cameras

The department found that a third-party agency conducted around 700 searches deemed “out of compliance” with its data-sharing policies.

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By Katie DeBenedetti









A Flock camera monitors the intersection at McKee Road and North White Road in San José on Apr. 2, 2026. The Menlo Park Police Department's decision to overhaul its data-sharing agreements comes after several other Bay Area law enforcement agencies

Menlo Park Police is tightening its [license plate reader](#) data-sharing policies after finding that an outside organization misused its data for the second time since 2025.

The department announced that it would nullify all existing data-sharing agreements after a June audit — which found that a regional anti-crime organization coordinating between law enforcement

Since 2024, Menlo Park Police has contracted with surveillance technology company Flock Safety to operate 35 of its Automatic License Plate Reader cameras, crediting the technology for helping

Flock's technology has been widely integrated by law enforcement agencies across the country in recent years, credited with "revolutionizing" their methods for solving crimes, but several law







A protester holds a sign during a rally opposing Berkeley's proposed contract expansion with surveillance company Flock Safety outside the Berkeley Unified School District boardroom in Berkeley on May 7, 2026. *(Gustavo Hernandez/KC)*

Flock advertises that its data-sharing offerings allow customers to share camera data with other contracted agencies on either a national, state or one-to-one sharing level. In part, the tool is ir
But its data-sharing practices have come under scrutiny after several data-sharing scandals, with clients accusing Flock of altering their data-sharing settings without permission and allowing
Many Bay Area agencies say they do not participate in the “National Lookup,” in line with California state law, which prohibits agencies from sharing license plate reader data with federal and

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Menlo Park Police said it shares data with other agencies on a one-to-one basis. Since the June audit, it said it would nullify existing sharing agreements and require partner agencies to execute new ones. Menlo Park Police has also instituted regular internal and external audits of its Flock system, following an investigation by [The Almanac](#) in 2025 that found its camera data was shared with private contractors. According to Menlo Park Police's most recent quarterly update, recent routine audits found no instances of noncompliance with its data-sharing permissions. But after the San Francisco Police Department's audit, both San Francisco and Menlo Park police departments authorized the Northern California Regional Intelligence Center, also known as NCRIC, to access their data at the time of the searches. "Although Menlo Park's data-sharing relationship with NCRIC was authorized and consistent with Department policy and applicable law when established, the Department immediately revoked the authorization."







In an aerial view, an automated license plate reader is seen mounted on a pole on June 13, 2024, in San Francisco, California. The city of San Francisco has installed 100 automated license plate readers across the city and plans to install

Menlo Park Police found that the agency conducted about 700 searches deemed “out of compliance” with its policy between February 2025 and June 2026.

None of the searches referenced Immigration and Customs Enforcement or immigration enforcement in their search justifications, the department said.

According to its [transparency portal](#), Menlo Park Police currently shares ALPR data with the East Palo Alto and South San Francisco police departments, the San Diego County District Attorn

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Earlier this month at a Police Advisory Committee meeting, the Redwood City Police Department revealed that its Flock cameras have also been improperly accessed multiple times since 2023. The department said the improper searches were “all errors and inconsistencies [that] resulted from Flock Safety’s mismanagement.” According to the committee report, Flock had enabled its cameras to be accessed by anyone with the right credentials. According to Redwood City Police Chief Kristina Bell, those searches didn’t yield any results, since they occurred before the city’s cameras were installed.

In 2024 and 2025, Redwood City Police identified additional improper searches by Flock clients who were miscategorized by the company as California law enforcement agencies. Flock also cut ties with [Stanford University](#) also quietly terminated its contract with Flock Safety and will replace its ALPR cameras with ones operated by a different company.

In January, [Santa Cruz](#) became the first city in California to cancel its contract with Flock. Other jurisdictions, including [Mountain View](#) and [Santa Clara County](#), have also distanced themselves from the company.

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